

أَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ
بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Lisan ul Quran — Lecture 29

The use of Dama'ir in the Murakkab Jarri

1. The governing principle

Rule: Some *Huroof ul Jarrah* are used with the *dama'ir* as well. Since the *Huroof ul Jarrah* put a noun into the state of *jarr*, the *dama'ir* used with them will also be those of the *state of jarr* — that is, the *Majroor Muttasil dama'ir*.

These are the same *dama'ir* studied in Lecture 25 in the place of the *Mudaf Ilayh*. The only difference is that there they joined a noun, and here they join a *Harf ul Jarr*.

The Majroor Muttasil Dama'ir

Form	Wahid	Tathniyah	Jam'
Mudhakkar Gha'ib	هُ	هُمَا	هُمْ
Mu'annath Gha'ib	هَا	هُمَا	هُنَّ
Mudhakkar Mukhatab	كَ	كُما	كُمْ
Mu'annath Mukhatab	كِ	كُما	كُنَّ
Mutakallim	يَ	—	نَا

(his · of those two · of them all ... my · our)

2. With the Harf ul Jarr Bi

The *Harf ul Jarr* بِ always comes with a kasrah. The singular masculine *Gha'ib* pronoun هُ, which ordinarily carries a dammah, changes to هِ when it comes with بِ — that is, a standing kasrah appears upon it.

The same change is seen in the dual and plural pronouns. هُما, هُم and هُنَّ, when used with بِ, become بهِما, بِهِم and بِهِنَّ respectively.

The reason: This is the same rule met in Lecture 25: if a kasrah or a silent yaa' comes before the pronoun, the dammah of هُ turns into a kasrah. بِ carries a kasrah, and that is why the change occurs.

Harf ul Jarr Bi	Wahid	Tathniyah	Jam'
Mudhakkar Gha'ib	بِهِ	بِهِمَا	بِهِمْ
Mu'annath Gha'ib	بِهَا	بِهُمَا	بِهِنَّ
Mudhakkar Mukhatab	بِكَ	بِكُمَا	بِكُمْ
Mu'annath Mukhatab	بِكِ	بِكُمَا	بِكُنَّ
Mutakallim	بِي	—	بِنَا

3. With the Lam ul Jarrah

The *Harf ul Jarr* لِ always carries a kasrah when used with a noun, as in لِرَزِيدٍ and لِحَامِدٍ — "for Zayd" and "for Hamid".

But with the Dama'ir: When the same *Lam ul Jarrah* joins the *dama'ir*, its vowel changes and a **fathah** comes upon the lam, as in لَهُمْ, لَهَا, and لَهُنَّ.

With the singular masculine *Gha'ib* pronoun the *Lam ul Jarrah* is read لَهُ, that is, with an inverted dammah, since a fathah now stands before it.

An important exception: The *Yaa' ul Mutakallim* always demands a kasrah on the letter before it. So when the *Lam ul Jarrah* comes with the *Yaa' ul Mutakallim*, the kasrah stays on the lam, and it becomes لِي, "for me".

Harf ul Jarr Li	Wahid	Tathniyah	Jam'
Mudhakkar Gha'ib	لَهُ	لَهُمَا	لَهُمْ
Mu'annath Gha'ib	لَهَا	لَهُمَا	لَهُنَّ
Mudhakkar Mukhatab	لَكَ	لَكُمَا	لَكُمْ
Mu'annath Mukhatab	لِكِ	لَكُمَا	لَكُنَّ
Mutakallim	لِي	—	لَنَا

Examples from the Qur'an

لَهُ مَا فِي السَّمُوتِ وَمَا فِي الْأَرْضِ

(Surah al-Hadid: 2)

Translation: To Him belongs whatever is in the heavens and whatever is in the earth.

لَكُمْ دِينُكُمْ وَلِيَ دِينِ

(Surah al-Kafirun: 6)

Translation: For you is your religion, and for me is my religion.

This short verse holds both cases together: in لَكُمْ the lam carries a fathah because a pronoun follows, and in لِيَ it carries a kasrah because the *Yaa' ul Mutakallim* follows.

لَنَا أَعْمَالُنَا وَلَكُمْ أَعْمَالُكُمْ

(Surah al-Qasas: 55)

Translation: For us are our deeds and for you are your deeds.

4. With the Harf ul Jarr Fee

فِي ends in a silent yaa', and when the pronoun هُ comes after it, that pronoun is written and read with a plain kasrah.

ذَٰلِكَ الْكِتَابُ لَا رَيْبَ ۚ فِيهِ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 2)

Translation: This is the Book about which there is no doubt.

Feeyya with the Yaa' ul Mutakallim

When the *Yaa' ul Mutakallim* joins فِي, two yaa's come together. In that case, by the rule of Arabic, the two are **merged** — a single yaa' is written but a shaddah is placed upon it.

فِي = يِ + يِ

(in me)

Harf ul Jarr Fee	Wahid	Tathniyah	Jam'
Mudhakkar Gha'ib	فِيهِ	فِيهِمَا	فِيهِمْ
Mu'annath Gha'ib	فِيهَا	فِيهِمَا	فِيهِنَّ
Mudhakkar Mukhatab	فِيكَ	فِيكُمَا	فِيكُمْ
Mu'annath Mukhatab	فِيكِ	فِيكُمَا	فِيكُنَّ
Mutakallim	فِيَّ	—	فَيْنَا

وَالَّذِينَ جَاهَدُوا فِينَا لَنَهْدِيَنَّهُمْ سُبُلَنَا

(Surah al-'Ankabut: 69)

Translation: And those who strive for Us — We will surely guide them to Our ways.

5. The Nun ul Wiqayah with 'An and Min

The Nun ul Wiqayah: This comes before the *Yaa' ul Mutakallim* and protects the vowel of what precedes it, which is why it is called the *Nun ul Wiqayah* — the noon of protection.

5.1 With 'An

The final letter of عَنْ is silent, and the *Yaa' ul Mutakallim* is silent too. A noon comes between them, which is the *Nun ul Wiqayah*.

عَنْ + نْ + يِ = عَنِّي

In عَيَّ the noon carries a shaddah, which means the noon has come twice — once as the original letter and once as the *Nun ul Wiqayah*.

Harf ul Jarr 'An	Wahid	Tathniyah	Jam'
Mudhakkar Gha'ib	عَنْهُ	عَنْهُمَا	عَنْهُمْ
Mu'annath Gha'ib	عَنْهَا	عَنْهُمَا	عَنْهُنَّ
Mudhakkar Mukhatab	عَنْكَ	عَنْكُمَا	عَنْكُمْ
Mu'annath Mukhatab	عَنْكِ	عَنْكُمَا	عَنْكُنَّ
Mutakallim	عَيَّ	—	عَنَّا

A fine point: In عَنْهُ the pronoun keeps its dammah; it does not become عَنِّه — because the noon of عَن is silent, carrying neither a kasrah nor a silent yaa' before it. This is exactly the difference between بِهِ and عَنْهُ.

5.2 With Min

The case of مِنْ is exactly the same.

$$\text{مِنْ} + \text{ن} + \text{ي} = \text{مِنِّي}$$

Harf ul Jarr Min	Wahid	Tathniyah	Jam'
Mudhakkar Gha'ib	مِنْهُ	مِنْهُمَا	مِنْهُمْ
Mu'annath Gha'ib	مِنْهَا	مِنْهُمَا	مِنْهُنَّ
Mudhakkar Mukhatab	مِنْكَ	مِنْكُمَا	مِنْكُمْ
Mu'annath Mukhatab	مِنْكِ	مِنْكُمَا	مِنْكُنَّ
Mutakallim	مِنِّي	—	مِنَّا

6. With Ila and 'Ala

It was met in Lecture 25 that when a *dameer* joins **إلى** and **لدى**, their *alif* changes into a *yaa'*. It is on this account that the pronoun following them also takes a *kasrah*, since a silent *yaa'* now stands before it.

Harf ul Jarr Ila	Wahid	Tathniyah	Jam'
Mudhakkar Gha'ib	إِلَيْهِ	إِلَيْهِمَا	إِلَيْهِمْ
Mu'annath Gha'ib	إِلَيْهَا	إِلَيْهِمَا	إِلَيْهِنَّ
Mudhakkar Mukhatab	إِلَيْكَ	إِلَيْكُمَا	إِلَيْكُمْ
Mu'annath Mukhatab	إِلَيْكِ	إِلَيْكُمَا	إِلَيْكُنَّ
Mutakallim	إِلَى	—	إِلَيْنَا

Harf ul Jarr 'Ala	Wahid	Tathniyah	Jam'
Mudhakkar Gha'ib	عَلَيْهِ	عَلَيْهِمَا	عَلَيْهِمْ
Mu'annath Gha'ib	عَلَيْهَا	عَلَيْهِمَا	عَلَيْهِنَّ
Mudhakkar Mukhatab	عَلَيْكَ	عَلَيْكُمَا	عَلَيْكُمْ
Mu'annath Mukhatab	عَلَيْكِ	عَلَيْكُمَا	عَلَيْكُنَّ
Mutakallim	عَلَى	—	عَلَيْنَا

Why the shaddah in Ilayya and 'Alayya?: The same rule of merging is at work here as in **فِي**. The *yaa'* of **إِلَى** and the *Yaa' ul Mutakallim* came together, so the two were merged and a shaddah placed upon a single *yaa'*.

Examples from the Qur'an

فَاتَّخَذَتْ مِنْ دُونِهِمْ حِجَابًا ۖ فَأَرْسَلْنَا إِلَيْهَا رُوحَنَا فَتَمَثَّلَ لَهَا بَشَرًا سَوِيًّا

(Surah Maryam: 17)

Translation: And she took a screen away from them; then We sent to her Our angel, and he appeared before her in the form of a well-proportioned man.

This single verse holds three *Murakkabat Jarriyyah* with pronouns: **لَهَا**, **إِلَيْهَا**, and **دُونِهِمْ**.

إِنَّ إِلَيْنَا إِيَابَهُمْ

(Surah al-Ghashiyah: 25)

Translation: Indeed to Us is their return.

لَسْتُ عَلَيْهِمْ بِمُصِيطِرٍ

(Surah al-Ghashiyah: 22)

Translation: You are not over them a controller.

ثُمَّ إِنَّ عَلَيْنَا حِسَابَهُمْ

(Surah al-Ghashiyah: 26)

Translation: Then indeed upon Us is their account.

7. All the particles at a glance

For convenience, the forms of every *Harf ul Jarr* in which a change occurs are gathered together. Look especially closely at the last two columns.

Harf	sing. masc. Gha'ib	plur. masc. Gha'ib	sing. Mutakallim	plur. Mutakallim
بِ	بِهِ	بِهِمْ	بِي	بِنَا
لِ	لَهُ	لَهُمْ	لِي	لَنَا
فِي	فِيهِ	فِيهِمْ	فِي	فِينَا
عَنْ	عَنْهُ	عَنْهُمْ	عَنِّي	عَنَّا
مِنْ	مِنْهُ	مِنْهُمْ	مِنِّي	مِنَّا
إِلَى	إِلَيْهِ	إِلَيْهِمْ	إِلَيَّ	إِلَيْنَا
عَلَى	عَلَيْهِ	عَلَيْهِمْ	عَلَيَّ	عَلَيْنَا

Three principles that follow from the table

- The pronoun هُ takes a kasrah only when a kasrah stands before it (as in بِهِ) or a silent yaa' (as in فِيهِ, عَلَيْهِ, إِلَيْهِ). Otherwise it keeps its dammah (as in لَهُ, عَنْهُ, مِنْهُ).
- With the singular *Mutakallim* pronoun there are three kinds of response: a plain joining (بِي, لِي), a merging with shaddah (فِي, عَلَيَّ, إِلَيَّ), and the *Nun ul Wiqayah* (مِنِّي, عَنِّي).
- The *Lam ul Jarrah* is the only particle whose own vowel changes to a fathah with a pronoun, except with the *Yaa' ul Mutakallim*.

About the Harf ul Jarr Ka: Among the eleven *Huroof ul Jarrah*, كَ is not ordinarily used with the *dama'ir*.

For likeness with a pronoun Arabic says مِثْلَهُ and not كَهُ. Likewise تَ and the waw of oath come only with nouns.

8. A Harf ul Jarr as a Silah

An important principle: If the Arabic *Huroof ul Jarrah* do not appear in their basic meaning with a noun, they are in fact being used **with a verb as a silah**, on account of which their meaning changes.

Sentence	Literal sense	Correct rendering
اللَّهُ يَسْتَهْزِئُ بِهِمْ	with them	Allah mocks them
الَّذِينَ يُؤْمِنُونَ بِالْغَيْبِ	with the unseen	those who believe in the unseen
سَخِرُوا مِنْهُ	from him	they used to mock him
وَمَا نَحْنُ لَكَ بِمُؤْمِنِينَ	for you	and we are not going to believe you

In the first example **يَسْتَهْزِئُ** is a verb and **بِ** has come with it as a *silah*, which is why the rendering is not "with them" but "mocks them".

قَالَ إِنْ تَسَخَرُوا مِنَّا فَإِنَّا نَسَخَرُ مِنْكُمْ كَمَا تَسَخَرُونَ

(Surah Hud: 38)

Translation: He said: if you ridicule us, then we will ridicule you just as you ridicule.

Here too **مِنْ** has come with the verb **سَخِرَ** as a *silah*, and it is rendered not "from" but "at".

9. A fine distinction between 'An and Min

Rule: **مِنْ** is generally used with things that pass over **bodily and materially**. Whereas **عَنْ** comes with things that are **incorporeal and immaterial** — that is, things that have no body and cannot be touched or felt.

Sentence	Translation	Reason
أَخَذْتُ الْكِتَابَ مِنْ أَسَاتِذِي	I took the book from my teacher	a book is a material thing that can be touched and felt
أَخَذْتُ الْعِلْمَ عَنْ أَسَاتِذِي	I gained knowledge from my teacher	knowledge is immaterial and cannot be touched or felt

A glimpse of this distinction in the Qur'an

أَلَمْ يَعْلَمُوا أَنَّ اللَّهَ هُوَ يَقْبَلُ التَّوْبَةَ عَنْ عِبَادِهِ

(Surah at-Tawbah: 104)

Translation: Do they not know that it is Allah who accepts repentance from His servants?

The immaterial thing in this verse is repentance. It is an inward and spiritual act, a state of the servant's heart and his turning back to Allah. That is why عَنْ has come here.

The use of Min in the event of the Mi'raj

سُبْحَنَ الَّذِي أَسْرَىٰ بِعَبْدِهِ لَيْلًا مِّنَ الْمَسْجِدِ الْحَرَامِ إِلَى الْمَسْجِدِ الْأَقْصَىٰ

(Surah Bani Isra'il: 1)

Translation: Exalted is He who took His servant by night from al-Masjid al-Haram to al-Masjid al-Aqsa.

A most subtle point: When the momentous event of the *Isra* and *Mi'raj* of the Prophet, peace be upon him, was set out in the Qur'an, Allah used the word مِنْ there, and not عَنْ.

The use of the form مِّنَ الْمَسْجِدِ الْحَرَامِ points to the reality that the blessed body of the Prophet, peace be upon him, was also part of that journey.

From this it becomes clear that the event of the *Mi'raj* was not merely spiritual but took place with both soul and body, and that Allah showed His noble Prophet, peace be upon him, His great signs.

Consider this: A point of belief is being established by the choice of a single *Harf ul Jarr*. This is one glimpse of the fineness of the Arabic language and of the inimitability of the Qur'an.

Summary

1. The Huroof ul Jarrah are used with the dama'ir too, and since they put a noun into the state of jarr, only the Majroor Muttasil dama'ir come with them.
2. With the Harf ul Jarr بِ the pronoun هُ changes to هِ, because بِ carries a kasrah.
3. Likewise هُم and هُمَا become بِهِمْ and بِهِمَا.
4. The Lam ul Jarrah takes a kasrah with a noun, but with the dama'ir a fathah comes upon it: لَهُمْ, لَهُمَا, لَهُنَّ.
5. With the singular masculine Gha'ib the Lam ul Jarrah is read لَهُ, that is, with an inverted dammah.
6. With the Yaa' ul Mutakallim the kasrah stays on the lam and it becomes لِي, since that yaa' demands a kasrah before it.
7. The verse لَكُمْ دِينُكُمْ وَلِيَ دِينَ of Surah al-Kafirun holds both cases together.
8. فِيْ ends in a silent yaa', so the pronoun after it takes a plain kasrah: فِيْهِ.
9. When the Yaa' ul Mutakallim joins فِي, two yaa's come together and are merged, written فِيْ.
10. The Nun ul Wiqayah comes before the Yaa' ul Mutakallim and protects the vowel of what precedes it.
11. Both عَنْ and مِنْ end in a silent letter, so the Nun ul Wiqayah comes before the Yaa' ul Mutakallim: عَنِّي and مِنِّي.
12. The shaddah on the noon in these two is because the noon has come twice — once as the original letter and once as the Nun ul Wiqayah.
13. In عَنْهُ and مِنْهُ the pronoun keeps its dammah, because the noon is silent and carries no kasrah.
14. When a pronoun joins إِلَى and عَلَى their alif changes into a yaa', which is why إِلَيْهِ and عَلَيْهِ are formed.
15. The shaddah in إِلَيَّ and عَلَيَّ is due to the same merging that occurs in فِيْ.
16. With the singular Mutakallim there are three kinds of response: a plain joining, a merging, and the Nun ul Wiqayah.
17. The Harf ul Jarr كَ is not ordinarily used with the dama'ir; كُنْ is said in its place.
18. If a Harf ul Jarr does not appear in its basic meaning, it is being used with a verb as a silah.
19. In اللَّهُ يَسْتَهْزِئُ بِهِمْ the بِ is a silah, which is why the rendering becomes "mocks them".
20. عَنْ comes with things that are material and bodily, and عَنْ with things that are immaterial.
21. This is why عَنْ was used for taking a book and عَنْ for gaining knowledge.
22. Repentance is an inward and spiritual act, which is why Surah at-Tawbah has عَنْ عِبَادِهِ.
23. The use of مَنْ الْمَسْجِدِ الْحَرَامِ in the event of the Mi'raj points to that journey having taken place with both soul and body.

Exercise

1. Which dama'ir are used in a Murakkab Jarri, and why?
2. Write the complete table of the Majroor Muttasil dama'ir.

3. What change occurs in the pronoun اُ with the Harf ul Jarr بِ, and why?
4. Write out the table of all the forms with بِ.
5. What vowel does the Lam ul Jarrah take with a noun and with a pronoun?
6. What is the exception in the Lam ul Jarrah? Give a Qur'anic example.
7. Separate both cases of the lam in the last verse of Surah al-Kafirun and give the reason for each.
8. Why does the pronoun اُ take a plain kasrah after فِي?
9. How is فِي formed? Write the rule of merging.
10. Define the Nun ul Wiqayah and explain why it is given that name.
11. Why is there a shaddah on the noon in عَيِّ and مَيِّ?
12. Why does the pronoun in عَنْهُ carry a dammah while in بِهِ it carries a kasrah?
13. What change occurs when a pronoun joins إِلَى and عَلَى?
14. Give the reason for the shaddah in إِلَى and عَلَى.
15. Write the singular Mutakallim form of every Harf ul Jarr and sort them into three groups.
16. What is meant by a Harf ul Jarr as a silah? Give three examples.
17. Write the literal and the correct rendering of اللَّهُ يَسْتَهْزِئُ بِهِمْ separately.
18. What is the fine distinction in the use of عَنْ and مِنْ? Give one example of each.
19. Why does Surah at-Tawbah have عَنْ عِبَادِهِ and not مِنْ?
20. What is established by the use of مِنْ in the event of the Mi'raj?

سُبْحَانَكَ اللَّهُمَّ وَبِحَمْدِكَ، أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ، أَسْتَغْفِرُكَ وَأَتُوبُ إِلَيْكَ

اللَّهُمَّ صَلِّ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا صَلَّيْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ
 اللَّهُمَّ بَارِكْ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا بَارَكْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ